

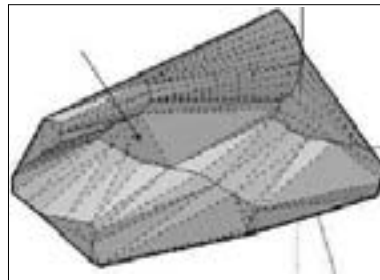
Typically, in TINs created from contours, SketchUp sometimes creates two triangles pointing opposite to each other (sharing a common base). It's useful to split these up and change the direction of one of these triangles so as to facilitate smoother manipulation of complex triangulated surfaces. The Flip Edge Tool does exactly that. You can activate the Flip Edge Tool from the Tools menu.

In the image below, you can see a Sandbox created from contours with the triangulated surface revealed. (If you can't see the Hidden Geometry in a Sandbox you've created, remember to click the 'View' menu and check the 'Hidden Geometry' option.)

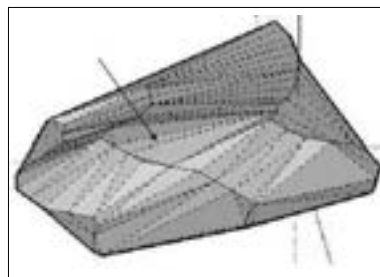
But the two large triangles creating a flat space in the middle of the TIN have been flipped to make several more manageable ones.

A few simple steps will help you un-mangle the triangulation on a TIN:

- Use the Sandbox from Contours Tool to make a terrain.
- Explode (by right click) or reveal the Hidden Geometry (using the View Menu).
- Select the Flip Edge Tool (Tools>Sandbox>Flip Edge).
- As you move the cursor over the TIN, you'll be able to highlight edges you should flip. Select by clicking on an edge.
- The shared edge (of the two triangles) will be removed and an edge perpendicular to it will appear in its place.



Back to back triangles could mean trouble



But the Flip Edge Tool flips things over